

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 945

By Walley

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Paula Langley Wilhite of Bolivar.

WHEREAS, we were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Paula Langley Wilhite of Bolivar; and

WHEREAS, Paula Wilhite was an exemplary public servant and consummate professional who worked assiduously to improve the quality of life for her fellow citizens in numerous capacities; and

WHEREAS, born on July 1, 1960, in Lauderdale County, Mrs. Wilhite was the daughter of Mildred Evangeline Bradford Langley and Curtis Voss Langley; and

WHEREAS, Mrs. Wilhite attended schools in Ripley, Bolivar, and Alcoa, and graduated from Alcoa High School; she earned a degree from Draughons Business College and began her professional career at Bagwell and Associates; and

WHEREAS, Paula Wilhite devoted thirty-six years of her career to the Bolivar Police Department, where she served as an administrative assistant to the chief of police and city court clerk before taking her much-deserved retirement; and

WHEREAS, her professional endeavors aside, Mrs. Wilhite was a member of the Association for the Preservation of Tennessee Antiquities and Daughters of the American Revolution, organizations that furthered her interest in history and genealogy; and

WHEREAS, she enjoyed reading, gardening, antiquities, the company of her friends, and family gatherings; she was happiest when surrounded by her family and was known as a reliable source for stories and knowledge of family trees; and

WHEREAS, Paula Wilhite was deeply devoted to her family and always endeavored to remain true to family values of the highest order; she relished her roles as a doting wife, mother, and grandmother, and loved showering her grandchildren with surprises; and

WHEREAS, she will be sadly missed but fondly remembered by her first love and husband of forty-two years, Harold Wilhite; her children, Emma (Austin) Scott and Henry Wilhite; her grandchildren, Wallace Scott, Emmett Scott, Evangeline Scott, and Hank Wilhite; her brothers, Curt (Sharon) Langley and Shannon Langley; her brothers- and sisters-in-law, Rick (Judy) Wilhite, Larry (Teresa) Wilhite, Jerry (Carla) Wilhite, and Frank (Christy) Wilhite; and a host of nieces and nephews who loved her dearly; and

WHEREAS, in addition to her parents, she was preceded in death by her father- and mother-in-law, Richard and Sally Wilhite, and her nephew, Richard Wilhite III; and

WHEREAS, Paula Wilhite practiced her faith at Bolivar First Methodist Church, where she taught Sunday School and was a member of various committees and the Bolivar Methodist Women's group; and

WHEREAS, Mrs. Wilhite lived her life with faith, grace, and courage, and she greatly impacted the lives of those who were blessed to know her; her life was a testimony of perseverance, love, and unwavering devotion to God, her family, and her community; and

WHEREAS, Paula Wilhite leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all her chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should pause to remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Paula Langley Wilhite,

reflecting fondly upon her impeccable character and her stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we express our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family and friends of Mrs. Wilhite.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.